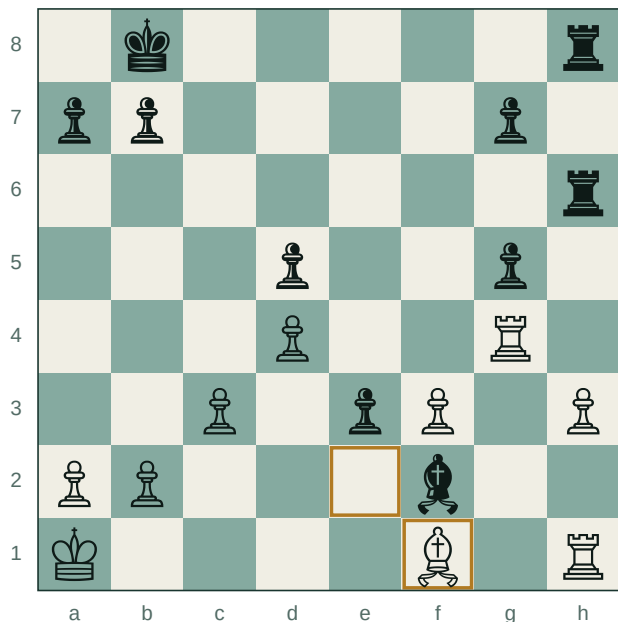


Calculated sacrifices: Black, move 38

Calculated sacrifices

Black to move



Previous move: 38.Bf1. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

38...Rhx3 39. Bxh3 e2 40. Rb1 Rxh3

38...Rhx3 The rook captures the pawn on h3. Recorded reply: **39.Bxh3**.

39...e2 The pawn moves from e3 to e2. Recorded reply: **40.Rb1**.

40...Rxh3 The rook captures the bishop on h3.

At the end, nominal material is White 15 / Black 14 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, Black's balance changes by -1. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does Black's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer:** -1: the balance goes from +0 to -1. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

An attractive attacking picture is not compensation by itself. Continue until the resulting position can be evaluated honestly.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

A sacrifice exchanges material for a concrete benefit. The benefit may be mate, a stronger attack, a recovered investment, or lasting activity; it must be shown through moves.

HOW TO LOOK

State what the sacrifice changes: a defender, a line, a king square, or a critical tempo. Calculate acceptance and plausible refusal.

The defending king is on a1. Geometrically undefended: rook on h1. Check for tactical protection.